

Grammar

Past Progressive

We form the past progressive with was/were + the -ing form of the verb. It describes an action that was in progress at a specific moment or period in the past.

Geçmiş zamanda süren eylem, was/were + fiil-ing ile kurulur. Geçmişte belirli bir anda veya süre boyunca devam eden bir eylemi anlatır.

When? We use the past progressive for actions in progress at a stated past time, for background actions in a story, and for two actions happening at the same time in the past.

Belirtilen bir geçmiş anda süren eylemler, bir hikayede arka plan eylemleri ve geçmişte aynı anda süren iki eylem için kullanılır.

Positive

- I/He/She/It + was + -ing
- You/We/They + were + -ing
- e.g. She was walking to the gym.

Negative

- I/He/She/It + wasn't + -ing
- You/We/They + weren't + -ing
- e.g. We weren't waiting long.

Question

- Was + I/he/she/it + -ing...?
- Were + you/we/they + -ing...?
- e.g. Were you queuing at the pharmacy?

Short answers

- Yes, I was. / No, I wasn't.
- Yes, they were. / No, they weren't.

Common mistakes

- ~~I was wait for the bus.~~ → **I was waiting for the bus.**
- ~~She were jogging in the park.~~ → **She was jogging in the park.**
- ~~They was queuing at the cinema.~~ → **They were queuing at the cinema.**
- ~~We wasn't using the gym.~~ → **We weren't using the gym.**

1. At nine o'clock, my sister _____ (study) at the library near the sports club.

2. The children _____ (play) outside when it began to rain.

3. Which sentence is correct?

- a. I was waiting for the bus.
- b. I were waiting for the bus.
- c. I was wait for the bus.
- d. I waiting for the bus.

4. They was shopping in the neighbourhood market. — *True / False*

5. Put the words in order: was / at 8pm / the pharmacy / closing

6. Rewrite in the negative: He was cycling to the gym. (He...)

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7. _____ you queuing at the cinema at six o'clock?

8. Turn into a question: They were waiting at the bus stop. (...)

9. While I _____ (shop) at the market, I lost my phone.

10. Choose the correct short answer: Were you commuting by bike? — ...

- a. Yes, I was.
- b. Yes, I were.
- c. Yes, I am.
- d. Yes, I commute.

Simple Past vs Past Progressive

We use the simple past for completed actions and the past progressive for actions in progress. Together, the past progressive shows the background action and the simple past shows the shorter action that interrupted it.

Tamamlanmış eylemler için geniş geçmiş zaman (simple past), süren eylemler için ise past progressive kullanılır. Bir arada kullanıldıklarında, past progressive arka plan eylemini, simple past ise onu kesen daha kısa eylemi gösterir.

When? Use 'while' with the past progressive for the longer action, and 'when' with the simple past for the shorter, interrupting action.

Uzun süren eylem için past progressive ile 'while', onu kesen kısa eylem için ise simple past ile 'when' kullanılır.

Positive

- Past progressive (background) + when/while + simple past (interruption)
- e.g. I was waiting when the bus arrived.

Negative

- I wasn't waiting when the bus arrived.
- They didn't see the accident while they were shopping.

Question

- What were you doing when the bus arrived?
- Were you waiting when it happened?

Short answers

- Yes, I was waiting. / No, I wasn't waiting.

Common mistakes

- ~~I waited when the bus was arriving.~~ → **I was waiting when the bus arrived.**
- ~~While she was shop, she was meeting a friend.~~ → **While she was shopping, she met a friend.**
- ~~The phone was ringing while we watched a film for a moment.~~ → **The phone rang while we were watching a film.**

1. I _____ at the bus stop when it started to rain.

- a. was waiting
- b. waited
- c. wait
- d. waits

2. While we _____ (queue) at the cinema, we _____ (meet) our classmates.

3. She was cycling to the gym when she was falling off her bike. — *True / False*

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4. Put the words in order: were / when / we / a taxi / took / it / raining / started

5. Combine: I was shopping. + I saw my teacher. (*While...*)

6. The receptionist _____ (call) my name while I _____ (read) a magazine.

7. Write one sentence using both tenses about a bus journey. (...)

8. Which sentence correctly shows an interruption?

- a. I was reading when the phone rang.
- b. I read when the phone was ringing.
- c. I was reading when the phone was ringing.
- d. I read when the phone rang for hours.

Question Tags

A question tag is a short question added to the end of a statement to check information or start a conversation. A positive statement takes a negative tag, and a negative statement takes a positive tag.

Question tag, bir bilgiyi doğrulamak veya sohbeti başlatmak için cümle sonuna eklenen kısa bir sorudur. Olumlu cümle olumsuz tag alır, olumsuz cümle olumlu tag alır.

When? We use question tags in everyday conversation to confirm facts, check opinions, or invite the listener to agree.

Günlük konuşmada bir bilgiyi doğrulamak, fikir sormak veya dinleyicinin katılımını istemek için kullanılır.

Positive

- Positive statement + negative tag (auxiliary + n't + pronoun)
- e.g. It's convenient, isn't it?

Negative

- Negative statement + positive tag (auxiliary + pronoun)
- e.g. It isn't convenient, is it?

Question

- The tag repeats the auxiliary/modal of the main sentence and matches its subject pronoun.
- e.g. You can walk there, can't you?

Short answers

- Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.
- Yes, I do. / No, I don't.

Common mistakes

- ~~The gym is new, is it?~~ → **The gym is new, isn't it?**
- ~~She doesn't like the bus, doesn't she?~~ → **She doesn't like the bus, does she?**
- ~~You were late, was you?~~ → **You were late, weren't you?**

1. The new sports club is expensive, _____?

2. You weren't at the pharmacy this morning, _____?

3. He can take the metro from here, _____ ?

- a. can't he
- b. can he
- c. does he
- d. doesn't he

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4. The bus was late, was it? — *True / False*

5. Put the words in order: cinema / to / the / isn't / far / it / , / ?

6. Add a tag: They don't use the gym often. (...)

7. Add a tag: The traffic wasn't too bad this morning. (...)

8. Which tag correctly completes: 'Let's take the metro, _____ ?'

- a. shall we
- b. don't we
- c. are we
- d. won't we